New York Electorate — Five Party-Resolved Cuts

Follow-on analyses, 2026-06-29, all from `scripts/diag_ny_electorate_extras.py` *against* `data/ny_vrdb.duckdb` *(voters, voter_participation) +* `data/ny_statewide.duckdb` *(voter_donor_affiliation, forecast_predictions). Companion to* `ny-turnout-by-party-age.md`*,* `ny-donor-class-by-party.md`*, and* `donor-class-and-the-electorate.md`*.*

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1. The unaffiliated "blank" bloc is young, disengaged, and donor-light

NY's 25% no-party enrollment is the recurring blind spot of registration-based analysis. Characterized against the major parties (active roll):

party	roll %	median age	%65+	%18-29	2024 turnout	donors/1k
DEM	47.7%	49	26.7%	17.3%	58.4%	33.0
REP	22.7%	55	30.6%	14.0%	**69.5%**	23.6
NOPARTY	25.1%	**42**	17.7%	**24.0%**	**50.4%**	**12.5**

The unaffiliated bloc is the **youngest** (median 42 vs DEM 49, REP 55), the **least likely to vote** (50.4% in a presidential year vs 69.5% for Republicans), and the **least likely to donate** (12.5 matched federal donors per 1,000 vs 33.0 for Democrats). It is not a bloc of high-information independents holding the balance — it is a younger, more disengaged quarter of the roll. (Republicans are the oldest and highest-turnout group.)

2. The donor class is more Democratic than the electorate in *every* competitiveness band

Mapping each matched donor to their congressional district's competitiveness (from `forecast_predictions` |margin|):

CD band	donors	%DEM	%REP	%NOPARTY	(registrant %DEM)
Tossup (<5)	17,878	57.7%	23.5%	14.6%	(40%)
Lean (5–10)	16,467	45.9%	32.6%	16.3%	(31%)
Likely (10–20)	68,341	41.7%	38.8%	14.8%	(33%)
Solid (20+)	**205,346**	71.6%	14.5%	11.3%	(56%)

Two findings: (1) the donor pool's %DEM **exceeds registration in every band** (e.g. Solid: 71.6% donor vs 56% registrant; Tossup 57.7% vs 40%) — the donor class is more Democratic than the electorate everywhere, not just in blue districts. (2) **The overwhelming majority of donors live in Solid districts** (205K of 308K, mostly Solid-D Manhattan), so campaign money originates in safe seats and flows out — consistent with the cross-state finding that safe seats *supply* most money even as competitive ones receive a premium.

3. The gray off-year electorate is behavior, not rolls — and most so for Republicans

Das-Gupta two-factor decomposition of the change in each party's 65+ electorate share, 2024 presidential → 2025 off-year (rate = differential turnout; composition = registration age structure):

party	65+ share (pres)	65+ share (off)	observed change	RATE effect	COMP effect
DEM	29.0%	32.1%	+3.2	**+2.5**	+0.7
REP	32.7%	42.8%	+10.2	**+8.7**	+1.5
NOPARTY	22.4%	30.6%	+8.2	**+7.5**	+0.6

For every party the **rate effect dominates composition ~5–6×**: the off-year electorate is older because the young *choose not to vote off-cycle*, not because the rolls are differently composed. This is the institutional, on-cycle-timing- fixable diagnosis — and it is **strongest for Republicans**, whose electorate ages +10.2 points off-cycle (almost entirely behavior).

4. New registrants are abandoning party labels — a secular shift to "blank"

Party mix and age of each year's *new* registrants still on the roll:

reg year	new regs	%DEM	%REP	%NOPARTY	median age at reg
2004	432,683	51.5%	21.5%	21.6%	30
2008	559,590	57.8%	16.2%	20.7%	29
2012	508,663	57.0%	15.5%	22.6%	29
2016	785,520	51.5%	18.5%	25.6%	30
2020	903,928	40.9%	21.3%	33.7%	30
2024	893,119	**39.7%**	22.1%	**35.6%**	29

The Democratic share of new registrants has fallen **~18 points** (57.8% in 2008 → 39.7% in 2024) while the no-party share rose **~15 points** (20.7% → 35.6%); Republican share is roughly flat. New entrants register at a stable ~29–30. The unaffiliated bloc (§1) is not a legacy artifact — it is **growing through new registration**, a leading indicator that the snapshot electorate understates. (Caveat: survivorship — only registrants still on the current roll appear, so older cohorts are thinned by moves/purges; read the *trend in party mix*, which is composition-based, as the robust cut.)

5. Safe-seat New York, from registration alone

District counts by registration lean (DEM% − REP%, active roll):

Congressional (26): Safe D (D+40+) **9** · Likely D **3** · Lean D **7** · Competitive (<5) **4** · Lean/Likely R **3** · Safe R 0.

Assembly (150): Safe D **55** · Likely D **31** · Lean D **19** · Competitive (<5) **17** · Lean/Likely R **21** · Safe R **7**.

By registration alone, **only 4 of 26 congressional and 17 of 150 Assembly districts (11%) are competitive**; 19/26 and 105/150 lean Democratic. This is the registration-side corroboration of the observed safe-seat map (`safe-seat-washington.md`): the general election is a foregone conclusion in the large majority of NY districts, which (per `ny-turnout-by-party-age.md` §E) throws the real decision to a small, enrollment-gated primary electorate.

Reproduce

```
STATE=NY python scripts/diag_ny_electorate_extras.py
```

Caveats carried from the source memos: turnout *rates* use a current-roll denominator (survivorship-biased for older cycles; composition shares are robust); the donor match is a conservative name+ZIP proxy (a floor); CD competitiveness is the model's predicted margin, not a certified result.